St. Alexis of Wilkes-Barre Orthodox Church

A Mission of the Orthodox Church in America

2323 N State St, Unit 112, Bunnell, FL 32110

Sunday Divine Liturgy 9:30 AM

Confessions heard Saturday after Great Vespers or by appointment

SUNDAY, OCTOBER 25 **TONE 4**

21st Sunday after Pentecost (5th of Luke)

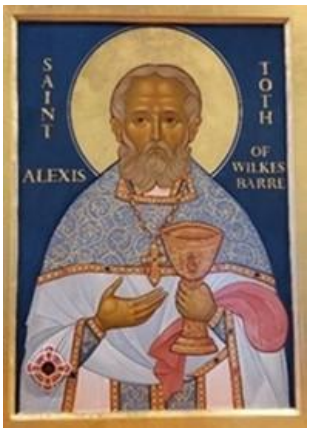
Martyrs Marcian and Martyrius the Notaries, of Constantinople

(& Saint Tabitha the Widow)



"The Orthodox Christian Church
is evangelical, but not Protestant.
It is orthodox, but not Jewish.
It is catholic, but not Roman.
It is not denominational,
it is pre-denominational.
It has believed, taught, preserved, defended,
and died for the Faith of the Apostles
since the Day of Pentecost
nearly 2,000 years ago."

– Our Life in Christ



Welcome to our Guests!

Thank you for coming to pray with us. You will find a blue guest information card next to the weekly bulletin with today's hymns on the table where you entered. Please fill out the card and give it to a greeter or place it in the *Tithes and Offerings* box. You are also invited to *Coffee Fellowship Hour* in the parish hall following the Liturgy this morning where our priest, Fr David, and others look forward to meeting you!

According to ancient Christian practice, Holy Communion (Eucharist) is served to members of the Orthodox Church who have made preparation through prayer, fasting, and recent confession, and who are at peace with their neighbor. If you are not a member of the Orthodox Church, you may be offered blessed bread (*antidoron*) by others in respect and love.

Announcements:

Many Years to Gillian *Brigid* **Taylor on the occasion of her Chrismation during the Liturgy today.** Welcome home!

Many Years to Maryam *Miriam* **Khusanova on the occasion of her Baptism during the Liturgy today.** Welcome home!

Nativity Decorating Team will meet today, Sunday October 25 in the Parish Hall following the Q&A session for the 2027 budget. We will meet Sunday October 25 to discuss decorating our new space for the Feast of the Nativity of Christ. This is for ***anyone*** interested in brainstorming ideas for decorating! If you are interested but unable to stay for the meeting, feel free to text/email your ideas & suggestions by **10/24** to **Carol Buriak** (540-526-7589 or c_buriak@yahoo.com). Thanks in advance to all!

Member-Missionary Map of the World
The world map hanging in the hallway across from the kitchen has small **blue pins** on the side. ***Members are invited to place a blue pin where they were born.*** All blue pins remain anonymous, helping us rejoice in the countries and cultures represented in our local parish and how the Body of Christ brings us together. **Green pins** indicate where our missionaries serve.

Want time with your priest during the week for confession or pastoral counsel? There's an app for that...or at least a link! https://www.stalexisoca.org/meet-with-priest Please note that any meeting scheduled with Fr David will be ***at the church*** unless otherwise requested. If no slots are available on the app, you may text or email Fr David requesting a meeting. He does schedule a limited number of meetings via Zoom on some Tuesdays and Thursdays.

SAVE THE DATE: Annual Parish Meeting SUNDAY NOVEMBER 1
(Agenda & 2027 Budget draft available)

The second Q&A session regarding the proposed 2027 Budget and **Agenda** will take place today October 25 after Coffee Fellowship Hour. Listen for the announcement!

Requirements to be a Voting Member at an Annual Parish Meeting:
Eligible voting members are at least 18 years of age, have been members of this local parish for a minimum of six months, support the local parish ministries financially as best as they are able, and are regular participants in the Holy Mysteries of Confession and the Eucharist.

St Alexis 2026 Annual Parish Meeting - Documents

Orthodox Conversations will be taking a brief recess and reconvene on **November 8**, the Sunday following the Annual Parish Meeting.

Encouraging ACH donations at St. Alexis for Tithes and Offerings and the Building Fund
If possible, please choose **ACH** rather than credit card transactions if giving online. Our parish is charged a 2.2% transaction fee for each credit card donation. In contrast, we are charged only $.25 for each ACH donation. To donate via ACH, register with **Church Connect**, a one-time, quick, secure set up:

Church Connect - Our St Alexis Orthodox Church App

- Scan the ***QR code*** with your smart phone to create your account
- You may also go directly to the link at: stalexisoca.org/give
- If you need help setting up your account, see Mka Rozanne or Mike Ruddy
- Note that payments to the Book Store are NOT payable online.

ONGOING Opportunities for Love and Ministry in our Parish:

- **Church Cleaning happens every Wednesday 3:30-5:30pm (Vespers begins at 6pm)**. Nelya Lashkul is a steward of this ministry. Ask her how you can help or contact the church office.
- **We are looking for volunteers for church projects and assistance in the office**. Stop in as you can!
- **Child Care**: Interested in helping our catechumens by providing supervision for their children during *Orthodox Conversations* each Sunday and catechism each Wednesday 6:30-7:30pm? This is a special ministry requiring at least two qualified adults. An honorarium may be available if needed for this ministry. See Fr David or Mka Rozanne to learn more.

- NOTE: According to OCA policies, anyone who works with children in the parish must submit to a background check and complete a briefing process. There must be two adults caring for children at all times unless the children are with a parent or relative.

❖ **We have a newly appointed Steward of International Missions for our parish: *Randall Gibbons*!** Randall will be the OCMC Ambassador for our parish and work with our priest and PC to enable us to not only make disciples in our "Jerusalem, Judea and Samaria," but also "to the ends of earth." (Acts 1:8) Interested in assisting him? Please see Randall or Fr. David!

Prayer Lists – Pray for each other daily:

The Departed:

- The Priest Slava
- The newly departed Stefan Stanescu
- Mka Catherine (Sissy) Yerger
- Geoff Nicholas Brueggen
- Nina Myasnikova
- Wesley Theophan Sheldahl
- Sandra Chan Ajram
- Jessica Joanna Wright
- Henry Poleschuk
- The unborn
- Victims of accidents, hostilities, and natural disasters around the world

All whom we carry in our hearts, including:

- Fr Aleksandr Yu Shi, Fr. Kung Ming Cheung, Fr. Denis
- Fr Patrick, Mka Lauren, James, Walter, Henry, Kathryn, Ethan, Marissa & the child she carries, Andrew
- The Harris, Drennan, Hargrave, & Kingery clergy families
- Archimandrite Sergius
- OCMC missionaries & staff including Hoppes, Doelmans, Brandows, MacDonalds, & Hannah Valentine
- Iconographers Elena & Anya and wood craftsmen who will build the sanctuary and iconostasis
- Ilya, Moses, Elena, Naomi, Danica, Stela, Gordana, Larry, Gabriel, Elizabeth, David, Lisa, Karla Anna, Jonathan
- Emilia and the child she carries
- Joanna and the child she carries
- The newly illumined Gillian *Brigid* and Maryam *Miriam* and their families and sponsors
- The newly illumined Vinnie *Vincent*, Amy *Maria*, Isabelle *Elizabeth* and their families and sponsors
- The newly illumined Noelle *Mary* and her family and godparents
- Catechumens Chris, Lesly, Gianna, Marco, Samuel, Tyler
- All members of our community traveling or on the bed of sickness
- All who are homeless, unemployed, or under-employed in our community
- All of our guests and inquirers seeking God through the Orthodox Church

Hymns for this Sunday: *Please sing along with the choir – and all week long!*

Tone 4 Troparion *(Resurrection)*
When the women disciples of the Lord
learned from the angel the joyous message of Thy Resurrection,
they cast away the ancestral curse
and elatedly told the apostles:
"Death is overthrown!
Christ God is risen,//
granting the world great mercy!"

Tone 4 Troparion *(St. Alexis)*
O righteous Father Alexis,
our heavenly intercessor and teacher,
divine adornment of the Church of Christ!
Entreat the Master of All
To strengthen the Orthodox Faith in America,
To grant peace to the world //
And to our souls great mercy.

Tone 3 Troparion *(Martyrs)*
In holy zeal you dispelled the error of Arius
and proclaimed the Trinity, one in essence.
Holy martyrs Marcian and Martyrius,
unshaken bulwarks of Orthodoxy,
entreat Christ our God to grant us His great mercy!

Tone 4 Kontakion *(Resurrection)*
My Savior and Redeemer
as God rose from the tomb and delivered the earth-born from their chains.
He has shattered the gates of hell,
and as Master,//
He has risen on the third day!

Tone 4 Kontakion *(Martyrs)*
From your youth you were good athletes, wise Marcian and Martyrius,
vanquishing the Arian heretics;
you kept the faith perfect by following in the footsteps of your bishop and teacher Paul,
therefore, you are worthy to be with him in eternal life, //
as respected defenders of the Holy Trinity.

Scripture Readings for this Sunday:

Epistle: Galatians 2:16-20
Romans 6:3-11 *(Baptism)*

Gospel: Luke 16:19-31
Matthew 28:16-20 *(Baptism)*

Life in our Church

Saturday, Oct 24	**Choir Rehearsal** *(in the nave)*	**3:30 PM**
	Great Vespers *(Confessions following)*	**5:00 PM**
Sunday, Oct 25	**Divine Liturgy of St. John Chrysostom**	**9:30 AM**
	Baptism *(Maryam Lashkul)* & **Chrismation** *(Gillian Taylor)*	
	Coffee Fellowship Hour	
	Open Discussion/Q&A *in nave*	**~12:30 PM**
	in preparation for ***Annual Meeting November 1***	
	(Agenda & 2027 Budget draft available)	
	Nativity Decorating Team Meeting *(Parish Hall)*	**~1:00 PM**

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Oct 27-30 Annual Thriving in Ministry Facilitators Retreat (Ruckers)

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Wednesday, Oct 28	**Church Cleaning**	**3:30 PM**
	Ninth Hour Prayers *(Catechism following)*	**6:00 PM**
Saturday, Oct 31	**Choir Rehearsal** *(in the nave)*	**3:30 PM**
	Great Vespers *(Confessions following)*	**5:00 PM**

Don't Forget: Turn Clocks Back One Hour Saturday Night!

Sunday, Nov 1	**Divine Liturgy of St. John Chrysostom**	**9:30 AM**
	Abbreviated Coffee Fellowship Hour (NO POTLUCK)	
	Annual Parish Meeting	**~12:00 PM**

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Wednesday, Nov 4	**Church Cleaning**	**3:30 PM**
	Vespers *(Catechism following)*	**6:00 PM**
Saturday, Nov 7	**Choir Rehearsal** *(in the nave)*	**3:30 PM**
	Great Vespers *(Confessions following)*	**5:00 PM**
Sunday, Nov 8	**Divine Liturgy of St. John Chrysostom**	**9:30 AM**
	Coffee Fellowship Hour	
	Orthodox Conversations	**12:30 PM**

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Wednesday, Nov 11	**Parish Council Meeting**	**3:30 PM**
	Church Cleaning	**3:30 PM**
	Vespers *(Catechism following)*	**6:00 PM**
Saturday, Nov 14	**Choir Rehearsal** *(in the nave)*	**3:30 PM**
	Great Vespers *(Confessions following)*	**5:00 PM**

** Nativity Fast begins Sunday, November 15**

Sunday, Nov 15	**Divine Liturgy of St. John Chrysostom**	**9:30 AM**
	Coffee Fellowship Hour	
	Orthodox Conversations	**12:30 PM**

His Grace, The Right Rev. GERASIM, Bishop of Ft. Worth, *Locum Tenens* of the Diocese of the South
Archpriest David C. Rucker ◊ 904-599-5812 ◊ priest@stalexisoca.org
Parish Council President James Humphries ◊ 904-540-2476
Helen Ireland, Treasurer, George Andrews, Jr., Secretary and Members-at-Large: Charles Fausey, Ali Marie Phipps, Karla Anna Ayer